

with no treatment. Wash your baby's face every day with water and baby soap and avoid lotions. If your the acne doesn't clear up on its own within 3 months, call your pediatrician.

Slow weight gain All babies lose weight in the first days, but most are back to their birth weight by the 10th day. After that, most babies gain about 1 oz (30 g) each day. Breastfed babies generally gain weight more slowly. If a baby loses more than 10 percent of their initial birth weight or is not putting on weight as expected, you will usually need to see a doctor to check why this has happened and what you should do.

Causes Slow weight gain is occasionally due to problems with breastfeeding; for example there may be problems with positioning and latching on, which mean that both mother and baby find it hard to establish breastfeeding. Another possible cause of poor weight gain is excessive [vomiting](#).

What to do If you're breastfeeding, make sure you have an adequate intake of fluids and calories (you need an additional 500 calories a day), since too little of either can affect milk supply. Getting enough rest is also important for a healthy milk supply. You may be advised to pump in addition to feeding your baby on the breast. Seeing a lactation consultant can help.

Jaundice This is a common condition in newborns that gives the skin a yellowish hue. Neonatal jaundice is usually caused by an excess of bilirubin, which is a substance normally produced during the breakdown of red blood cells.

Physiological jaundice is the most common type of jaundice. Newborns have an excess of red blood cells. Since the baby's liver is immature, it is unable to metabolize red blood cells quickly enough, which leads to a buildup of bilirubin. This type of jaundice. However, if bilirubin levels are very high, this can damage part of the brain, so to avoid this, treatment is given with phototherapy lamps. The baby is placed, naked, under a special light or wrapped in a fiberoptic blanket. The lights help break down the bilirubin. Treatment is done for a few days, in the hospital or at home. Physiological jaundice usually appears two or three days after birth and goes away within two weeks.

Pathological jaundice This is a more serious type of jaundice that can cause a rapid breakdown of the red blood cells and is usually due to an incompatibility between the mother's and the baby's blood. This may need urgent treatment.

Breast-milk jaundice The most usual cause of prolonged jaundice is breast milk. This is thought to be caused by a substance in the milk that can make bilirubin levels rise. The recommended treatment depends on the bilirubin level. Doctors often recommend nursing the baby at least 8 to 12 times a day, initially, to help their body get rid of the bilirubin. If jaundice continues beyond two weeks of age and is not thought to be due to breast milk, this should be investigated.

Vomiting All babies vomit to some extent in the first weeks after the birth, but you should contact your doctor if your baby has prolonged or excessive vomiting, isn't gaining enough weight, or you're concerned. Serious vomiting can have several causes, including conditions such as gastroesophageal reflux and [pyloric stenosis](#). Other symptoms that may accompany vomiting can suggest particular conditions and will need investigating. If a baby seems lethargic or floppy, this could indicate an infection; if their abdomen is swollen, this could suggest an intestinal obstruction; if vomit is bright yellow or green, there could be a twisted bowel; and if there is also diarrhea, there may be gastroenteritis.

Gastroesophageal reflux If your baby is miserable, in pain, arching their back, refusing feedings, or vomiting large amounts after feedings, they could be suffering from gastroesophageal reflux. This occurs when the valve between the bottom of the